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Chaco Canyon, a settlement of the ancient Anasazi culture in North America, had massive buildings. **It must have been a major Anasazi center.** Analysis of wood samples shows that some of the timber for the buildings came from the Chuska and San Mateo mountains, 50 miles from Chaco Canyon. **Only a major cultural center would have the organizational power to import timber from 50 miles away.**

In the argument given, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first is a premise used to support the argument's main conclusion; the second is the argument's main conclusion.

B. The first is the argument's main conclusion; the second is a premise used to support that conclusion.

C. The first is one of two premises used to support the argument's main conclusion; the second is the other of those two premises.

D. The first is a premise used to support the argument's main conclusion; the second is a premise used to support another conclusion drawn in the argument.

E. The first is inferred from another statement in the argument; the second is inferred from the first.

Argument Construction

Situation The ancient Anasazi settlement at Chaco Canyon had massive buildings, for which some of the timber came from mountains 50 miles away.

Reasoning *What roles do the statement that Chaco Canyon must have been a major Anasazi center and the statement that only a major center would have the organizational power to import timber from 50 miles away play in the argument?* The first and third sentences in the passage are both factual observations. Since no further support is provided for either of them, neither can be a conclusion in the argument. The final sentence (i.e., the second **boldfaced** portion of the argument) is a speculative generalization about major cultural centers. None of the other statements gives us any reason to think this generalization is true, so it cannot be a conclusion in the argument either. However, the third and fourth sentences together imply that Chaco Canyon was a major cultural center, and the first sentence indicates that it was Anasazi. So, together, the first, third, and fourth sentences all support the claim that Chaco Canyon was a major Anasazi cultural center and thus more generally a major Anasazi center, as the second sentence asserts. Therefore, the first, third, and fourth sentences are all premises that jointly support the second sentence (i.e., the first **boldfaced** portion of the argument) as a conclusion.

A. As explained above in the Reasoning section, the first **boldfaced** sentence is a conclusion supported by the second **boldfaced** sentence, not the other way around.

B. **Correct.** As explained above in the Reasoning section, the first **boldfaced** sentence is the argument's only stated conclusion, and thus is its main conclusion, while all the other sentences are premises used to support it; therefore, the second **boldfaced** sentence (*Only a major cultural center . . . 50 miles away*) is a premise used to support the conclusion.

C. As explained above in the Reasoning section, the first **boldfaced** sentence is the argument's conclusion, not a premise used to support the conclusion.

D. As explained above in the Reasoning section, the first **boldfaced** sentence is the argument's only stated conclusion, and there is no reason to suppose that the argument is intended to lead to any other tacit conclusion that the second **boldfaced** sentence is intended to support.

E. As explained above in the Reasoning section, the first **boldfaced** sentence is inferred from the three other statements in the argument together, not from any one of them alone. The second **boldfaced** sentence is a speculative generalization that cannot be, and is not meant to be, inferred from the first **boldfaced** sentence or from any other statement in the argument.

The correct answer is B.

•

Paper and plastic grocery bags are a continuing problem for the city, both as litter and in landfills. To discourage their use, the city council has proposed a tax on each bag to be paid by the supermarkets that supply them. Several

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use, the city council has proposed a tax on each bag to be paid by the supermarkets that supply them. Several environmental groups, however, oppose the tax despite having brought the issue to the council's attention in the first place.

Which of the following, if true, would best explain the environmental groups' opposition to the proposed tax?

A. The city's current tax revenue is insufficient to pay the cost of recycling paper and plastic grocery bags.

B. The cost to the city of collecting and disposing of a grocery bag is greater than the proposed tax per bag.

C. Plastic bags account for 90 percent of the grocery bags that litter the city's streets and take up space in landfills.

D. Only supermarkets distributing more than a certain number of grocery bags each month would be subject to the proposed tax.

E. Supermarkets plan to pass the tax on to consumers, who are unlikely to change their behavior based on the small increase in their grocery bills.

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation Because paper and plastic grocery bags cause problems for a city, the city council wants to tax grocery stores for each bag they use in order to disincentivize the use of such bags. Some environmental groups regard the bags as a problem but nonetheless oppose the tax.

Reasoning *What would cause opposition to the council's solution?* The environmental groups regard the bags as a problem and want a solution. Therefore, there is likely to be some reason why those groups oppose the *specific* solution, a tax, put forward by the city council.

A. The city's *current* tax revenue is unlikely to explain the opposition of environmental groups to the plan to tax bags since the new tax would presumably increase that revenue.

B. The cost of disposing of bags is not relevant to the question of whether the council's planned tax would be an effective way to reduce the use of such bags.

C. The proportion of plastic bags in overall bag litter is not relevant to the question of whether the proposed tax would reduce the use of disposable bags.

D. While limiting the tax to certain stores might reduce the effectiveness of the plan, it would not explain why environmental groups think the plan would be generally ineffective and therefore oppose it as a solution.

E. **Correct**. If environmental groups believe the proposed tax on disposable bags will not be an effective disincentive and will make no appreciable difference in their use, those groups might oppose the tax in order to encourage the city council to seek a better solution. Since the tax will be passed on to consumers and may be too low to discourage such consumers from using disposable bags, that fact would explain the environmental groups' opposition.

The correct answer is E.

•

Regulations will not allow a pesticide that is toxic to humans to be used inside houses unless the pesticide will dissipate completely from the air within eight hours after its application. One test pesticide manufacturers typically use to determine how quickly anti-termite pesticides dissipate involves spraying the pesticides on the walls of room-sized plywood boxes and then timing their dissipation.

Which of the following would it be most useful to know in order to evaluate whether a dissipation time of just under eight hours on the manufacturers' test indicates an anti-termite pesticide that is toxic to humans obeys regulations for use in houses?

A. Whether anti-termite pesticides dissipate more slowly in furnished rooms than in plywood boxes

B. Whether people who apply anti-termite pesticides typically wear protective equipment that prevents them from being exposed to the pesticide

C. Whether people whose house is being treated with anti-termite pesticide generally know they should remain out of their house during the hours immediately after the pesticide's application

D. Whether there are anti-termite pesticides toxic to humans that, when subjected to the manufacturers' test, dissipate completely from the air in the boxes in well under eight hours

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dissipate completely from the air in the boxes in well under eight hours

E. Whether anti-termite pesticides that are not toxic to humans tend to take longer to dissipate than those that are toxic

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation Pesticides toxic to humans are not approved for residential use unless they dissipate completely within eight hours after being sprayed. To determine whether certain pesticides dissipate within the required timeframe and so meet regulations, manufacturers spray them in plywood boxes and then check to see if they have dissipated eight hours later.

Reasoning *What additional factor could affect the question of whether the pesticides meet regulations?* The manufacturers' test relies on the assumption that the pesticides behave the same way in a plywood box as they would in a typical residence. It would therefore be helpful to know if that assumption is accurate, or if conditions in a residence might affect the speed at which pesticides dissipate.

A. **Correct.** If the pesticides dissipate more slowly under typical residential conditions, such as furniture being present, then pesticides that dissipate in slightly less than eight hours in a plywood box might take longer than that to dissipate in a home and would therefore not meet regulations.

B. The regulations in question do not concern the exposure of the workers who apply pesticides, so whether or not they wear protective gear is not helpful in determining if those regulations are met.

C. The knowledge of people in houses treated with pesticides affects their exposure to those pesticides, not whether the pesticides meet regulations.

D. The fact that some pesticides dissipate faster than others is not relevant to the question asked. That question is: What additional information would be useful in evaluating pesticides that barely succeed in meeting the manufacturer's eight-hour test?

E. The relative dissipation rates of toxic versus nontoxic pesticides are not relevant to the question of whether the toxic pesticides meet regulations.

The correct answer is A.

•

Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

In a typical year, Innovair's airplanes are involved in 35 collisions while parked or being towed in airports, with a resulting yearly cost of $1,000,000 for repairs.

To reduce the frequency of ground collisions, Innovair will begin giving its ground crews additional training, at an annual cost of $500,000. Although this will cut the number of ground collisions by about half at best, the drop in repair costs can be expected to be much greater, since _____.

A. most ground collisions happen when ground crews are rushing to minimize the time a delayed airplane spends on the ground

B. a ground collision typically occurs when there are no passengers on the airplane

C. the additional training will focus on helping ground crews avoid those kinds of ground collisions that cause the most costly damage

D. the $500,000 cost figure for the additional training of ground crews includes the wages that those crews will earn during the time spent in actual training

E. most ground collisions have been caused by the least experienced ground-crew members

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation An airline will give its ground crews additional training to reduce the frequency of the collisions its airplanes are involved in while parked or being towed in airports.

Reasoning *What premise would most logically support the conclusion that the additional training will reduce repair costs from ground collisions much more than it reduces the number of such collisions?* The key word *since* before the blank shows that the argument should be completed with a premise that

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word *since* before the blank shows that the argument should be completed with a premise that supports the preceding claim that the *drop in repair costs can be expected to be much greater*. What statement would support that claim? Note that the annual cost of training, $500,000, is half as much as the yearly cost of the repairs needed as a result of ground collisions, $1,000,000. We are told that the training will cut the number of ground collisions by at most about half, so if the drop in repair costs will be much greater than half, which would need to be the case to make the training worthwhile, what would have to be true of the ground collisions that the training will help the ground crews avoid? Presumably, they would have to be among the higher repair cost collisions, as opposed to the less serious collisions that result in lower repair costs. That is, the collisions that are avoided would have to make up more than half of the repair costs, so they would have to be costlier than average, given that the number of collisions avoided is no more than half. Thus, it would be quite useful to include in the argument a premise providing evidence that the training will help avoid the sorts of ground collisions that lead to above average repair costs.

A. We are given no reason to believe that the additional training would affect how much ground crews rush to minimize delays.

B. The number of passengers is not clearly relevant to the repair costs resulting from a ground collision and in any case would not be affected by additional ground crew training.

C. **Correct.** If the training especially helps the ground crews avoid those kinds of collisions that cause the most costly damage—that is, damage from ground collisions that has higher repair costs than the average repair costs for damage from ground collisions—then it will probably reduce repair costs by more than half.

D. Whether the cited expense for training includes wages is irrelevant to whether the training will reduce repair costs more than it reduces the number of collisions.

E. This suggests that the additional training may help reduce the number of collisions, not that it will reduce repair costs more than it reduces the number of collisions.

The correct answer is C.

•

Many agriculturally intensive areas of the world are beginning to encounter water scarcity problems. As a result, many farmers in these areas are likely to reduce their output as the water supply they need in order to maintain production shrinks. However, one group of farmers in such a region plans to increase their production by implementing techniques for water conservation.

Which of the following, if true, would most strongly support the prediction that the group's plan will succeed?

A. Farmers who can gain a larger share of the food market in their regions will be better positioned to control more water resources.

B. Most agricultural practices in areas with water shortages are water-intensive.

C. Other regions of the world not facing water shortages are likely to make up for the reduction in agricultural output.

D. Demand for agricultural products in the group's region is not expected to decline.

E. More than half the water used for agriculture in the farmers' region is lost to evaporation or leakage from irrigation channels.

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation Farmers in many agriculturally intensive regions will probably reduce their output because the regions' water supplies are dwindling, but one group of farmers in such a region plans to use water conservation techniques to increase their output.

Reasoning *What would provide evidence that water conservation techniques will help the farmers increase production despite their region's dwindling water supplies?* In order for the water conservation techniques to be effective, they must result in significantly more water becoming available for the farmers to use. Because overall supplies are shrinking, rather than growing, that can only happen if the farmers are currently losing or wasting a great deal of water in ways that could be prevented with water conservation techniques.

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A. This suggests an advantage the farmers will gain if their water conservation plan enables them to increase production, but it provides no evidence that the plan actually will enable them to increase production.

B. This suggests that the plan would have to yield quite a lot of conserved water in order for the farmers to increase production, but it offers no evidence that the plan will do so. Thus, it provides some reason to question whether the plan will succeed.

C. Whether regions without water shortages will increase production is not directly relevant to the question of whether a particular measure would lead to increased production in one region that does have a water shortage.

D. This has some slight, indirect relevance to the question of whether the farmers' plan will succeed: it suggests that if the farmers do manage to increase production, they will continue to have a market for what they produce. However, it does not address the issue of whether they will be able to increase production. Furthermore, even if demand for agricultural products in the group's region were expected to decline, it could still remain high enough to support the farmers' increased output from their water conservation plan.

E. **Correct.** This suggests that the farmers are losing a lot of water in ways that the water conservation techniques might prevent, so it provides evidence that employing some such techniques could enable the farmers to save enough water to increase their output.

The correct answer is E.

•

Scientists propose placing seismic stations on the floor of the Pacific Ocean to warn threatened coastal communities on the northwestern coast of the United States of approaching tidal waves caused by earthquakes. Since forewarned communities could take steps to evacuate, many of the injuries and deaths that would otherwise occur could be avoided if the government would implement this proposal.

The answer to which of the following questions would be most important in determining whether implementing the proposal would be likely to achieve the desired result?

A. When was the last time that the coastal communities were threatened by an approaching tidal wave?

B. How far below sea level would the stations be located?

C. Would there be enough time after receiving warning of an approaching tidal wave for communities to evacuate safely?

D. How soon after a tidal wave hits land is it safe for evacuees to return to their communities?

E. Can the stations be equipped to collect and relay information about phenomena other than tidal waves caused by earthquakes?

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation In order to provide advance warning of tidal waves threatening coastal communities, scientists suggest the government should install stations to measure seismic activity on the ocean floor. The passage argues the advance warning provided by these stations would allow communities to evacuate and therefore prevent significant numbers of deaths and injuries.

Reasoning *What would affect the question of whether the seismic stations would effectively prevent deaths and injuries?* The proposed seismic stations will only achieve their intended result—preventing significant numbers of deaths and injuries in coastal communities—if the warnings from those stations arrive far enough in advance of an oncoming tidal wave to allow the affected communities to evacuate in time. A warning that comes too late will be unhelpful.

A. The time elapsed since the *last* tidal wave has no bearing on whether or not seismic stations will prevent deaths from the *next* tidal wave.

B. The depth at which undersea stations are placed is not obviously relevant to the question of whether those stations will achieve their intended result.

C. **Correct.** If warnings from the seismic stations arrive too late for communities to evacuate safely, then those stations might not prevent many deaths and injuries among the affected population and could conceivably even make the situation worse—for example, by creating traffic jams on vulnerable coastal roads.

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D. The question of when evacuees could return has no bearing on whether the seismic stations would have the desired effect of preventing deaths.

E. The stations are intended to protect against tidal waves specifically, so other data those stations provide might be useful but are not relevant to whether the stations achieve their intended purpose.

The correct answer is C.

•

Because the cork stoppers in wine bottles can leak, crumble, or become moldy, winemakers must often discard a significant proportion of their inventory of bottled wine. Bottlemaster, Inc., produces a plastic stopper that cannot leak, crumble, or mold. **Bottlemaster's plastic stopper is available to winemakers for a price only slightly higher than that of traditional cork stoppers**, and cork prices are expected to rise considerably in the near future. Therefore, **Bottlemaster's plastic stopper will increase its share of the market for wine-bottle stoppers**.

In the argument given, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first and the second each provide evidence to support the conclusion of the argument.

B. The first presents information that, in light of other information presented, provides evidence to support the conclusion of the argument; the second is that conclusion.

C. The first is evidence that has been used to support a position the argument opposes; the second is the conclusion of the argument.

D. The first is evidence that has been used to support a position that the argument opposes; the second provides evidence to support the conclusion of the argument.

E. The first is a claim the argument challenges; the second is a conclusion on which that challenge is based.

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation Winemakers must often discard a notable percentage of their total bottled wine due to issues with the corks employed. A plastic stopper made by Bottlemaster is not susceptible to the same problems corks have. These stoppers cost slightly more than corks, but cork prices are likely to rise soon. Therefore, Bottlemaster's stoppers will become a larger percentage of the total of bottle-stoppers sold.

Reasoning *What functions do the two **boldfaced** phrases perform?* The first **boldfaced** phrase states the plastic stoppers cost slightly more than corks—a fact that, taken out of context, would not be expected to increase their market share. However, in the light of other information presented—corks cause expensive waste, and corks will become more expensive soon—the slightly higher price for plastic stoppers becomes evidence that such plastic stoppers may actually be cost-effective already, and moreover may soon be cheaper than corks or at least competitive. This in turn supports the conclusion in the second **boldfaced** phrase: Plastic stoppers will achieve increased market share.

A. While the first phrase does provide evidence in context, the second phrase is the conclusion, not further evidence.

B. **Correct.** The first phrase states plastic stoppers are slightly more expensive than corks; in the light of other evidence presented, namely the expected price increase for corks and the costly waste corks cause, this fact becomes evidence for the conclusion in the second phrase: Plastic stoppers will increase market share.

C. While it is possible that the fact in the first phrase—plastic stoppers cost slightly more—has been used at some point to support an opposing position, there is no evidence suggesting it is meant to function that way in the context of the argument.

D. The first phrase is not used to support an opposing argument, and the second phrase is the conclusion, not evidence for the conclusion.

E. The argument does not challenge the claim in the first phrase but instead contextualizes that claim; the conclusion in the second phrase is not meant to provide a basis for any such challenge.

The correct answer is B.

•

Only a reduction of 10 percent in the number of scheduled flights using Greentown's airport will allow the delays that

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Only a reduction of 10 percent in the number of scheduled flights using Greentown's airport will allow the delays that are so common there to be avoided. Hevelia airstrip, 40 miles away, would, if upgraded and expanded, be an attractive alternative for fully 20 percent of the passengers using Greentown airport. Nevertheless, experts reject the claim that turning Hevelia into a full-service airport would end the chronic delays at Greentown.

Which of the following, if true, most helps to justify the experts' position?

A. Turning Hevelia into a full-service airport would require not only substantial construction at the airport itself but also the construction of new access highways.

B. A second largely undeveloped airstrip close to Greentown airport would be a more attractive alternative than Hevelia for many passengers who now use Greentown.

C. Hevelia airstrip lies in a relatively undeveloped area but would, if it became a full-service airport, be a magnet for commercial and residential development.

D. If an airplane has to wait to land, the extra jet fuel required adds significantly to the airline's costs.

E. Several airlines use Greentown as a regional hub, so that most flights landing at Greentown have many passengers who then take different flights to reach their final destinations.

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation To avoid the delays now common at Greentown's airport, the number of scheduled flights there would need to be reduced by 10 percent. If the nearby Hevelia airstrip were expanded and upgraded, it would be an attractive alternative for 20 percent of Greentown airport's passengers. Still, experts do not believe that the delays at Greentown would end even if Hevelia were turned into a full-service airport.

Reasoning *Which statement most supports the experts' position?* If the number of flights at Greentown's airport did not drop by at least 10 percent, despite the fact that 20 percent of the passengers who currently use Greentown's airport would find nearby Hevelia airstrip an attractive alternative, then the delays would not be avoided. Airlines generally use certain airports as regional hubs—an airport through which an airline routes most of its traffic—so, even if many passengers would be willing to use Hevelia airstrip, the number of flights at Greentown may not decline significantly, or at all.

A. The experts' position concerns what would happen to the flight delays at Greentown airport if the Hevelia airstrip were converted into a full-service airport. So, the fact that there are great costs involved in making such a conversion—possibly making it unlikely—has no bearing on the effects such a conversion would have on flight delays at Greentown if it were to be carried out.

B. This statement indicates that the undeveloped airstrip near Greentown might be a better way to alleviate flight delays at Greentown, but it tells us nothing about the effects that converting the Hevelia airstrip to a full-service airport would have were it to be carried out.

C. This in no way explains why converting the Hevelia airstrip into a full-service airport would not alleviate the problem with flight delays at Greentown.

D. This provides a reason to think that reducing the number of flights at Greentown might make the airport more efficient. But that has no bearing on the effect that converting the Hevelia airstrip to a full-service airport might have on flight delays at Greentown.

E. **Correct.** This statement provides support for the experts' position because it gives a reason for thinking that the number of scheduled flights at Greentown would not be reduced, even if Hevelia airstrip became an attractive alternative for some 20 percent of Greentown's passengers.

The correct answer is E.

•

Farmer: Worldwide, just three grain crops—rice, wheat, and corn—account for most human caloric intake. To maintain this level of caloric intake and also keep pace with global population growth, yields per acre from each of these crops will have to increase at least 1.5 percent every year, given that the supply of cultivated land is diminishing. Therefore, the government should increase funding for research into new ways to improve yields.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the farmer's argument depends?

A. It is solely the government's responsibility to ensure that the amount of rice, wheat, and corn produced worldwide keeps pace with global population growth.

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worldwide keeps pace with global population growth.

B. Increasing government funding for research into new ways to improve the yields per acre of rice, wheat, and corn crops would help to increase total worldwide annual production of food from these crops.

C. Increasing the yields per acre of rice, wheat, and corn is more important than increasing the yields per acre of other crops.

D. Current levels of funding for research into ways of improving grain crop yields per acre have enabled grain crop yields per acre to increase by more than 1.5 percent per year worldwide.

E. In coming decades, rice, wheat, and corn will become a minor part of human caloric intake, unless there is government-funded research to increase their yields per acre.

Argument Construction

Situation The farmer states that although the worldwide human population is increasing, the supply of cultivated land is decreasing. We thus need to increase yields for the food crops that account for most of human caloric intake—rice, wheat, and corn—if we are to maintain our existing caloric intake. The increase in yields, according to the farmer, would need to be at least 1.5 percent every year.

Reasoning *What must be true if we are to accept the farmer's conclusion, that the government should increase funding for research into new ways to improve crop yields, on the basis of the above statements?* The farmer uses the above statements as premises of an argument for an increase in government funding for research on crop yields. Supposing that the farmer's statements are true, we need to find in the available options the statement that, if added to the argument, may allow us to accept the farmer's conclusion, based on the argument.

A. Whether or not nongovernmental entities such as NGOs (nongovernmental organizations) are responsible for helping to ensure that humans have an adequate amount of food, governments may or may not also have this responsibility.

B. **Correct.** If government funding of this research does not increase crop yields, then the premises of the argument provide no support for the conclusion that the government should provide such funding. The cogency of the argument thus depends on this statement.

C. Crops in addition to rice, wheat, and corn could also be very important, and perhaps essential for human existence. However, this would not diminish the importance of food crops such as rice, wheat, and corn.

D. This option may suggest that current levels of funding of research into crop yields are sufficient for purposes of our obtaining the necessary crop yields.

E. This option suggests that rice, wheat, and corn may be replaced by other crops, because the other crops have better yields. Because we might thus have a means for increasing crop yields that does not involve an increase in government research funding, this option may actually decrease the support for the conclusion.

The correct answer is B.

•

The air quality board recently informed Coffee Roast, a small coffee roasting firm, of a complaint regarding the smoke from its roaster. Recently enacted air quality regulations require machines roasting more than 10 pounds of coffee to be equipped with expensive smoke-dissipating afterburners. The firm, however, roasts only 8 pounds of coffee at a time. Nevertheless, the company has decided to purchase and install an afterburner.

Which of the following, if true, most strongly supports the firm's decision?

A. Until settling on the new air quality regulations, the board had debated whether to require afterburners for machines roasting more than 5 pounds of coffee at a time.

B. Coffee roasted in a machine equipped with an afterburner has its flavor subtly altered.

C. The cost to the firm of an afterburner is less than the cost of replacing its roaster with a smaller one.

D. Fewer complaints are reported in areas that maintain strict rules regarding afterburners.

E. The firm has reason to fear that negative publicity regarding the complaints could result in lost sales.

Evaluation of a Plan

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Evaluation of a Plan

Situation After being informed of a complaint about smoke from its coffee roaster, a firm decided to purchase and install an afterburner to reduce or eliminate emissions of smoke, even though the roaster roasts too little coffee at a time for an afterburner to be legally required.

Reasoning *What would have been a good reason for the firm to buy and install the afterburner?* The only factors mentioned that might give the firm reason to buy an afterburner are the complaint about smoke and the regulations requiring an afterburner. Since the regulations do not apply in this case, the complaint is more likely to have motivated the firm's decision. Any serious potential consequences the firm might have faced from failure to address the complaint could have provided a good reason to buy and install the afterburner.

A. If this debate had still been ongoing when the firm made its decision, uncertainty about the pending regulations might have justified the decision. But the debate had already been settled before the firm decided to purchase the afterburner, and the regulations clearly did not require one.

B. An unspecified alteration in flavor is not clearly a good reason to use an afterburner—the afterburner might worsen the flavor.

C. The firm's roaster was already small enough that the regulations did not require it to be replaced, even without an afterburner.

D. This reason relates only to rules regarding afterburners, not to Coffee Roast's purchase of an afterburner, which was not mandated by regulations. Furthermore, it could be that the air quality regulations recently enacted are among the strictest in any region, which could result in fewer complaints regardless of whether Coffee Roast installs an afterburner.

E. **Correct.** Since installing an afterburner is a plausible way to address the complaint and prevent future complaints, the firm has plausible reasons to believe this strategy will help it avoid the negative publicity and lost sales it fears. These considerations could have reasonably justified its decision.

The correct answer is E.

•

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